PRELIMINARY DESIGN PLAN · v0.1

Naija Banker

A Nigerian banking life-simulation game

Hit target. Survive MPR. Don’t japa.

Naija Banker turns the daily pressure of Nigerian banking into a game: targets, ultimatums, network downtime, audits, owambes and the monthly performance review. Players choose a bank and a desk, then try to climb from Banking Officer to AGM without burning out, getting sacked or getting suspended.

Document	Preliminary design plan and storytelling brief
Prepared by	Shakir Adeyemi
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Status	Draft for discussion. Prototype v0.2 is playable in the browser.
Inspiration	Lagos Life, the viral Nigerian browser life-sim built by Shalom Mathew

1. The pitch

One-liner. The Sims meets a Nigerian banking hall: you have one month, one target and one Branch Manager who does not want stories.

Logline. A fresh graduate resumes at a Lagos bank branch. Every week brings a new palava, and every month ends at the MPR table, where the Regional Director decides whether you rise, get a query letter, or receive the famous “your services are no longer required” letter.

Punchy taglines

- **Target is life.** The core promise of the game.
- **Hit target. Survive MPR. Don’t japa.** Main marketing line.
- **Your BM doesn’t want stories.** For social posts and trailers.
- **From banking hall to boardroom.** Career-ladder line for the store listing.
- **Network is down. Your target is not.** Meme-friendly line for X and TikTok.

Why this can work

- **Proven appetite.** Lagos Life showed that a browser game about everyday Nigerian pressure can spread fast. It reportedly passed one million players soon after launch.
- **Shared, painful, funny experience.** Almost every Nigerian has queued in a banking hall, chased a failed transfer or been called by an RM. Bankers and ex-bankers will recognise every scene.
- **Insider authenticity.** The design draws on real branch experience: MPRs, deposit mobilisation, KYC, month-end rollovers, ATM disputes and Head Office deadlines.
- **No install.** Like Lagos Life, it runs in a mobile browser, so a shared link is the whole onboarding.

2. Story and world

Premise

You are a new Banking Officer. You choose one of 26 fictional banks and one of three desks. The bank, the branch and the desk shape your month. The game never tells you the right way to bank; it shows you the trade-offs between target, integrity and your own sanity.

Narrative arc

Act	Grade span	What the player feels
1. Resumption	Banking Officer	Overwhelmed. Learning the rules, the queue, the jargon and the BM’s moods.
2. The grind	Senior Banking Officer to Assistant Manager	Targets climb 10% every month. Shortcuts and envelopes start to look tempting.
3. The politics	Deputy Manager to Manager	Mergers, rights issues, regulator visits and headhunters. Loyalty is tested.
4. The boardroom	Assistant General Manager	Victory: a Prado, a regional target and a reminder that the cycle continues.

The cast

Character	Role in the story
Branch Manager (BM)	Your daily boss. Sets ultimatums, notices lateness, remembers everything.
Regional Director	Chairs the MPR. Delivers the verdicts and the best one-liners.
Executive Director (ED)	Rare, unannounced visits. Can make or break your month in one conversation.
Internal Control	The auditors. Reward clean files, punish shortcuts.
HR	Promotions, car loans, query letters and rights-issue “encouragement”.
Customers	Chiefs in Lekki, Mama Ronke at Balogun, church treasurers, angry men in agbada.
The colleague	Your desk partner, who may japa at any moment and leave you her workload.
The headhunter	Brings offers from rival banks: more pay, harder targets.

Tone

Affectionate satire. The game laughs with bankers, not at them. Humour comes from recognition (“the meeting was about planning the next meeting”), never from mocking customers or any real institution. Copy uses everyday Nigerian English with light Pidgin and Yoruba flavour, kept readable for every region.

3. Core game loop

Cycle	What happens	Design purpose
Week	Three time slots: Morning, Afternoon, Evening. Pick one task per slot.	Fast, phone-friendly decisions with clear trade-offs.
End of week	A random event card with 2–3 choices.	Surprise, humour and moral pressure.
Month	Four weeks, then the MPR meeting with an A–D rating stamp.	A tense, shareable climax every 5–8 minutes of play.
Career	Good ratings earn promotion points. Targets rise 10% per month.	Long-term goal and reason to come back.

Player stats

Stat	Goes up with	Lose condition
Target progress	Field work, client visits, deals	Two D ratings in a row: sacked

Stat	Goes up with	Lose condition
Stress	Long hours, ultimatums, traffic	Reaches 100: burnout and japa
Boss goodwill	Hitting pace, covering for colleagues	Reaches 0: services no longer required
Compliance	KYC, reconciliations, refusing envelopes	Reaches 0: suspended after audit
Account balance	Salary, (risky) envelopes	Shown on the end screen as a score

> **Key tension.** Every fast route to target costs stress, compliance or goodwill. The player who hits target honestly and stays sane is the real winner.

4. Desks and career ladder

Desk	Target unit	Signature activities
Customer Service Officer	Accounts opened	Account-opening desk, Balogun market storm, complaints queue, KYC backlog, ATM disputes
Relationship Manager	Deposits (₦ millions)	Lekki HNI visits, government MDA chase, church treasurer, rollovers, SME loans, Friday ultimatum
Head Office Analyst	Deliverables	MPR deck for the ED, suspense GL reconciliation, CBN returns, IT downtime, “quick” meetings

Ladder. Executive Trainee → Banking Officer → Senior Banking Officer → Assistant Manager → Deputy Manager → Manager → Assistant General Manager. An A rating earns 2 points, a B earns 1, and 4 points trigger a promotion.

5. The banks

All 26 banks are fictional. They are shaped like the real industry’s tiers but carry no real names, logos or figures, which avoids trademark and defamation risk.

Group	Banks	How they play
Tier 1	Kora, Obsidian, Apex Crest, Tangerine Trust, Unity Atlantic	Biggest targets and pay; national networks; Bank of the Year parties
Tier 2	Bluewave, Lumen, Sterlix, Vela, Primeleaf, Ecoline, Northstar, Keyline, Harmony, Titanium Trust, Premia Trust	Mixed health; rights issues, merger rumours, regulator-appointed boards
Foreign	Stanmore, Global Metro	Premium city branches; highest pay; corporate only
Boutique	Providence Plus, Globex, Signet	Few branches, big tickets, HNI and oil money

Group	Banks	How they play
Regional	Parallax, Optima	Lean teams, gentler targets, you do everything
Non-interest	Barakah, Noor, Amanah	Northern or South-West footprint; Sharia advisory flavour

Each bank sets: target and pay multipliers, weekly stress, starting compliance, branch cities, capital position (strong, raising, or regulator watch) and a 1–5 difficulty rating.

6. Event library

Category	Examples
Branch life	Network don go · Third Mainland Bridge · ED on the floor · Surprise audit
Ethics	The envelope (₦50,000 to skip KYC) · Pay the ATM complaint from the till · Recycle last quarter's deck
Social	Owambe aso-ebi · 3-hour church service for an account · Japa season
Money	Staff car loan · Rights issue via salary deduction
Bank-wide	Merger rumours · Depositors panic after a viral tweet · Board dissolved · Branch closures · Headhunter offer

Copy bank: lines that sell the game

"Bring ₦50 million by Friday or don't come on Monday." — Branch Manager

"Everybody's market is tough." — Branch Manager

"Fair is not excellent. Close the gap next month." — Regional Director

"Replacement is in the pipeline. It has been in the pipeline since 2024." — HR

"The meeting was about planning the next meeting." — Narrator

"The BM was standing at the door. "Good afternoon," she said." — Narrator

"Oga is not on seat. Come back next week." — Narrator

7. Roadmap

Version	Theme	Scope
v0.2 (done)	Playable prototype	3 desks, 26 banks, ~25 events, MPR, promotions, local save
v0.3	Depth	Named BM and Regional Director with moods; CSO → RM → BM career path; 60+ events; sound and stamp animation
v0.4	Social	Shareable MPR result card for WhatsApp and X; daily challenge; bank-vs-bank leaderboard

Version	Theme	Scope
v1.0	Multiplayer	Accounts, regional leaderboards, players as colleagues in the same branch, refer-a-client between players
Later	Live world	Seasonal events (December rush, budget season, recap deadline), creator tools for new events

8. Business model (early thinking)

- **Free to play** in the browser, no ads in the first versions so it spreads.
- **Cosmetics:** outfits (Friday wear, agbada for owambe), office upgrades, desk plants.
- **Sponsored learning:** optional “financial literacy” events from fintechs or training providers, clearly labelled.
- **B2B spin-off:** a training version for bank onboarding and soft-skills programmes, a natural fit for X-CHAQ consulting.

9. Risks and mitigations

Risk	Mitigation
Real banks feel mocked or named	Fully fictional banks, people and figures; affectionate tone; clear disclaimer
Game seen as encouraging fraud	Shortcuts always carry visible consequences; integrity is rewarded
Viral traffic breaks servers	Stay static and browser-only until multiplayer; then use a managed backend
Repetitive after a few months	Grow the event library fast; add seasons and community-written events
Copycats after launch	Ship quickly, build the community, keep authentic insider content

10. Success measures for the first 90 days

- Players who finish their first MPR (target: over 70%)
- Average months played per session
- Share rate of MPR result cards
- Day-7 return rate
- Banker sign-ups who submit an event idea

11. Open questions

1. Keep three separate desks, or start everyone as a CSO and let them earn the RM and Head Office tracks?
2. How much Pidgin and Yoruba is right before the game stops feeling national?
3. Should players be able to own a branch (become BM) and set targets for NPC staff?

4. Which brand owns the game: X-CHAQ LTD, a new studio name, or a partnership?
5. Web only for now, or wrap as a Play Store app at v0.4?